

Create multiple users from a CSV file containing username and password

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Creates multiple user accounts on a Linux system by reading username and password pairs from a CSV file passed as an argument.

Language

bash

Category

system-administration

Command

```
sudo awk -F, 'NR>1 {print $1,$2}' "$1" | while read user  
    pass; do sudo useradd -m "$user" && echo "$user:$pass" |  
    sudo chpasswd; done
```

Explanation

The command reads a CSV file (passed as first argument) where each row contains a username and password. It skips the header row (NR_1), then for each subsequent row extracts the username and password fields. For each user, it creates a system account with a home directory (-m) and then uses chpasswd to set the plain text password from the CSV file.

Tags

user-management, bulk-operations, system-administration, csv, automation

Dependencies

coreutils, shadow-utils, openssl

Arguments

1. **CSV_FILE** (Required): Path to CSV file with username,password format

Examples

1. `echo -e 'username,password\{\}nuser1,pass123\{\}nuser2,pass456' > users.csv && sudo awk -F, 'NR>1 {print $1,$2}' "users.csv" | while read user pass; do sudo useradd -m -p $(openssl passwd -1 "$pass") "$user"; done` - Create users from users.csv file with username,password format
2. `sudo awk -F, 'NR>1 {print $1,$2}' "/path/to/users.csv" | while read user pass; do sudo useradd -m -p $(openssl passwd -1 "$pass") "$user"; done` - Create users from a specific CSV file path
3. `alias bulkaddusers='sudo awk -F, '""'NR>1 {print $1,$2}'""' "$1" | while read user pass; do sudo useradd -m -p $(openssl passwd -1 "$pass") "$user"; done'` - Create an alias for bulk user creation

Output

```
Creating users from users.csv:
user1: user created
user2: user created
```

Notes

- The CSV file should have a header row and contain username,password in each subsequent row
- Requires sudo privileges to create users
- Uses openssl to properly hash passwords for useradd
- The -m flag creates a home directory for each user
- The command skips the first line (header) with `NR<1`
- For better security, consider using a more robust password hashing method
- The CSV file must be passed as the first argument to the command

Warnings

- This command requires sudo access and will modify system user accounts
- Passwords are passed in cleartext in the CSV file which is a security risk
- The default password hashing method (`openssl passwd -1`) uses MD5 which is not the most secure

- Always backup your system before running bulk user creation
- Ensure CSV file permissions are secured to prevent unauthorized access
- Test with a single entry first before running on multiple users
- Consider using a more secure method for password handling in production environments

See Also

- [user-activity-and-quota-report](#)
- [nonhuman-user-activity-and-quota-report](#)

Status

draft

Safety

caution

Shell

bash

Platforms

linux, gnu-linux

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